

JEFF ZELLER

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Team-oriented partnerships, marketing, business development, and operations executive with a proven track record in go-to-market strategy and partnerships for leading sports, music, and technology brands. Deep experience in DTC/streaming content (SVOD, AVOD) and managing complex, multi-channel campaigns. Proven experience in F1, UFC, and global sports league partnership management, activation, and commercialization. Day-to-day expertise in account management, commercial and marketing partnerships, digital marketplace operations, sponsorship and IP licensing, branded merchandise, and complex, global, multi-channel campaigns. Tuned in to the intersection of sports, entertainment, technology, and media.

RECENT CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- 2026: Introduced Samsung Galaxy Card, the company's first ever US co-branded credit card, alongside Barclays US.
- 2025: Launched Tap to Transfer with Samsung, an innovative, interoperable real-time P2P payment solution in the US.
- 2024: Negotiated and signed a global licensing and commercial agreement utilizing several core Visa products.
- 2023: Hosted multi-day strategic and account planning in-person workshops with Visa & Samsung C-suite executives.
- 2022: Led GTM strategy and marketing campaign launches with global sports partners including F1, UFC, and PSG.
- 2021: Launched ESPN's Amazon shop and product partnerships with Topps, Stephen A. Smith, Adidas (sneaker).
- 2020: Led several partnership co-marketing campaigns for Emmy-winning ESPN documentary *The Last Dance*.

EXPERIENCE | PAYMENTS PARTNERSHIPS & BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

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|--------------|---|---------------------|
| 2023-present | VISA | NEW YORK, NY |
| 2026-present | Director, Strategic Initiatives & Operations, Global Brand Marketing, Consumer Products | |
| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">○ Lead the operational strategy for B2B2C marketing across marketing, product, and business units, aligning capital investment cases to scale high-growth affluent and cross-border consumer portfolios. | |
| 2023-2026 | Director, Global Strategic Digital Partnerships & Business Development, Big Tech | |
| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">○ Global Account Executive for Samsung, responsible for the pipeline, sales, negotiation, implementation, and day-to-day digital wallet operations of a partner driving \$1.75Bn in Visa payment volume annually.○ Worked with matrixed regional AEs to build and execute strategic plans, including driving business development deals like the launch of Samsung's first ever US co-brand credit card alongside Barclays.○ Built client relationships at both the working group and senior executive level, going above and beyond to meet client needs; achieved dramatic YoY increase in client's Net Promoter Score to +100 in 2024. | |

EXPERIENCE | SPORTS PARTNERSHIPS & MARKETING

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| 2021-2023 | CRYPTO.COM | NEW YORK, NY |
| | Sr. Director, Sports NFT Partnerships, Business Operations & Marketing | |
| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">○ Owned and executed digital and experiential NFT program activations for top-tier global sports league partners (UFC, F1, FIFA World Cup, Aston Martin Racing, PSG, LA Kings, Angel City FC, 76ers).○ Managed internal and external stakeholders across legal, privacy, and data to advance projects responsible for \$5M in incremental annual revenue, signing a dozen IP-led licensing agreements.○ Developed, codified, and rolled out operations playbooks; defined and streamlined work processes at scale; improved operating model for a distributed, remote team managing a \$15M ARR platform.○ Presenting speaker at NFT.NYC; featured on speaker panels for Benzinga, Bloomberg Linea, ASIAR.○ Managed a team of 8 (3 direct, 5 layered reports) across Content Ops, Marketing/Social, and Editorial. | |
| 2019-2021 | ESPN | NEW YORK, NY |
| | Director, Brand & Entertainment Marketing Partnerships + Consumer Products | |
| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">○ Pitched and executed creator, partner, social, and co-marketing campaigns and asset development with Peloton, Spotify, GIPHY, and Nike (Jordan) to support Emmy-winning documentary <i>The Last Dance</i>.○ Owned day-to-day operations of ESPN's licensed consumer merchandise, leading strategy, product development, and marketing; launched official ESPN shop on Amazon, '86 Mets collabs with Mitchell & Ness (apparel) / Topps (sports cards), and a sold-out, co-branded "Top Ten" Adidas Originals sneaker.○ Drove strategic paid and owned marketing channel efforts for ESPN's presence in sports betting, ranging from affiliate link-out deals to the development and launch of the ESPN Bet brand and YouTube channel.○ Concepted, creative directed, and launched <i>Hype Hits</i>, ESPN's arena music playlist brand (<i>Jock Jams</i> spiritual successor), followed by <i>Shots of Hype</i>, a spoken-word EP in collaboration with Disney Music. | |

EXPERIENCE | MUSIC PARTNERSHIPS & STRATEGY

2018-2019 **SONY MUSIC ENTERTAINMENT** **NEW YORK, NY**

Chief of Staff / Associate Director, Digital Strategy & Executive Communication

- Supported the President, Global Digital Business & US Sales organization (No. 22 on *Billboard's* 2019 Power 100), managing strategy and communications for the 1,000-person group within SME.
- Developed and delivered Keynote presentations to Sony's global executive team, ranging from strategic mid-range planning to investment theses and growth projections for the \$4 billion SME business.
- Conducted rigorous industry, company, and business model analysis to set strategic course, including identifying prospective sectors and companies for investment, partnership, or acquisition.

2016-2018 **AZ MANAGEMENT / DANCING ASTRONAUT** **STOCKHOLM, SWE / NEW YORK, NY**

Founder / CEO

- Avicii A&R intern; led "Waiting for Love" remix package, securing debut remix from Marshmello.
- Led a 25-person news outlet for the dance and electronic music industry with 350,000 MAUs, 1.25 million social media followers, 13 million monthly impressions, and annual revenue of \$250,000.
- Oversaw strategic product development, partnerships, and new revenue initiatives including an adtech stack upgrade, a YouTube MCN partnership, sponsored social posts, and branded merchandise.
- Supported Swedish artist Johnning (1B+ streams, RIAA Gold record), building profile and support team.

EXPERIENCE | TV & MOVIE CONTENT PARTNERSHIPS

2010-2014 **APPLE** **CUPERTINO, CA**

Content Producer & Marketer, iTunes TV, Movies & Music

- Spearheaded end-to-end GTM strategy and campaign execution for hundreds of TV series and marquee events (Super Bowl, Comic-Con), managing 50+ global partners (incl. ESPN, NFL, HBO, Disney).
- Coordinated comprehensive, season-long campaign planning, collaboratively driving Apple ecosystem promotion across TV, Music, and App to maximize relevance, tune-in, and purchase conversion.
- Proactively led the development and implementation of a real-time video content tracking database to replace legacy FileMaker platform; worked with engineers to validate impact, scope, build, and release.
- Co-curated Dance/Electronic genre page; liaised with labels, managers, and artists on new music promo.

BOARD, ADVISORY & MENTORSHIP

- 2023-present | Board of Governors (Secretary), The West Side Tennis Club
- 2023-present | Alumni Mentor, Harvard Business School Mentor Match Program
- 2017-present | Alumni Mentor, Stanford Alumni Mentoring Program / Cardinal Conversations
- 2017-2021 | Industry Advisor, Stampede CFP / Bumper Collective Crowdfunding Platform

EDUCATION

2014-2016 **HARVARD BUSINESS SCHOOL** **CAMBRIDGE, MA**

Master of Business Administration. Winner, multi-school Entertainment Case Competition. Elected to section leadership board. Founded Sound Society music club & speaker series; hosted The Chainsmokers, Alison Wonderland, and industry execs. Completed *Intro to Music Law* course at Harvard Law School.

2005-2009 **STANFORD UNIVERSITY** **PALO ALTO, CA**

Bachelor of Science, Management Science and Engineering. Concentration: Organization, Technology & Entrepreneurship. National Merit Scholar. SCTE Scholarship Winner. Men's varsity tennis scholarship athlete; elected captain junior/senior years; led team to #1 NCAA team ranking & tournament quarterfinals.

SKILLS Integrated, full-funnel marketing campaigns. Digital marketplace operations. Go-to-market strategy. Client partnerships. Executive communication. Team leadership. Negotiation. Sales & business development.

COMMUNITY Winner of San Francisco's "Mr. Marina 2014" competition (LLS cancer fundraiser/talent show). HBS Dean's Award 2016 finalist for exceptional community contribution. 2009 Spirit of Stanford Award Winner.

PERSONAL Tennis player. Member, West Side Tennis Club (ex-US Open site). Collector of music, sports cards, coins. From Denver. Wife Monika, children Jordan (5), Madison (4), identical twins Sydney & Savannah (1.5).

FUN FACTS Twin. Featured on cover art of Grammy-winning track "Don't Let Me Down." 2004 Colorado 5A tennis state champion. Wrote Stanford admissions essay on Steve Jobs and the iPod. DJ'd House of Blues Boston.